risk of public disorder. The Muslims and Hindus of Punjab planned to make common cause in their shared concern over the plight of their respective people. Despite this, '[o]n his return from the procession at about 7.30 p.m. the Deputy Commissioner received the order of Government that Drs. Kitchlew and Satyapal were to be escorted quietly to Dharmsala'.[24] This was an unnecessary act of deliberate government provocation. It risked the situation immediately deteriorating. The government authorities would have known that the deportation out of Punjab of these two leaders could goad an entirely peaceful gathering of people into agitation. Even then, however, '[t]he situation as it presented itself did not seem to argue any serious results as likely to arise from the arrests' because '[t]here had been no signs of enmity to Europeans as such; during the *hartal* [. . .] of the proceding Sunday Europeans had been walking about among the crowd quite unmolested'.

So remote was the risk of impending violence that the authorities' settled view was that '[w]hat was considered a more likely occurrence was that an attempt might be made to rescue the deportees on the way, and to meet this danger the Deputy Commissioner asked Mr. Rehill, the Superintendent of Police, the only responsible officer who knew the way, to accompany the escort'.[25] The authorities did not stop there. The colonial authorities continued to push their luck. Not content to let matters rest there, '[a]s regards Amritsar, it was decided that no crowd should be allowed to cross the railway line, and three European Magistrates were detailed to the three main crossings, and on the following morning received written orders to the effect that any crowd attempting to cross the line was to be dealt with as an unlawful assembly'. So the ordinary people of Punjab were criminalized at the stroke of a pen as participating in an unlawful assembly even if they only wished to go to the railway line while Drs Kitchlew and Satyapal were escorted to Dharamshala some 200 km way. Therefore, it is plain to see from this how the law was inducted, and the courts used, in the installation and execution of a framework of coercive colonial legalism.

If these 1919 'secret' reports are anything to go by, it is clear that as early as the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre, British officials in Lahore believed that